



The options in Proxomitron

unwanted data. It is a proxy server that acts as a filter between the Net and the browser. By controlling the requests being sent by the browser and the content channelled to it, it can clean up a browsing experience from ads, malware, pop-ups, etc. It can also act as a privacy tool by restricting browsers from sending data to Web pages.

Proxomitron, as mentioned, is a proxy server, which means that to use it, the browser needs to be configured to use a proxy. This can be done under the browser options. The HTTP proxy field has to be set to 127.0.0.1 with port number as 8080, and you're set.

The next time you visit a Web site, you can see that ads are no longer displayed; rather, just an "advertisement" label shows up. This is because Proxomitron already comes with a list of ad servers that are blocked. Additionally, Proxomitron can be further configured to exclude different Web page elements like Flash animation, pop-up windows etc. and prevent Web pages from controlling browsing by using a script—like preventing right-clicks or hiding the main menu of the window through JavaScript, which some Web sites do to prevent visitors from copying content, notably images.

Needless to say, Proxomitron is required only if there's no browser add-on that satisfactorily cleans up the Web. But it is an advanced tool and offers many more options, making it an essential tool to try out.